

Intravenous Insertion – Peripheral

Guideline Title: Intravenous Insertion - Peripheral

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CCCVI. **PURPOSE:** To provide vascular access via peripheral vein(s) for the purpose of providing support to the circulatory system and to maintain adequate circulation through the administration of IV fluids, blood products, and medications.

CCCVII. **DEFINITIONS:**

A. IV – Intravenous

CCCVIII. **DEPARTMENT GUIDELINE:**

A. **EQUIPMENT:**

- i. IV flush solution: 0.9% Normal Saline
- ii. Over the needle catheters (14g - 24g)
- iii. Site prep and securing equipment: Saline lock, gauze pads, alcohol pads, occlusive dressing, and tape.

B. **INDICATIONS:** The need or potential need to administer IV fluids, blood products, or medications.

C. **CONTRAINDICATIONS:**

- i. **ABSOLUTE:** None.
- ii. **RELATIVE:** Vessels distal to large lacerations, or fractures should be avoided, vessels in extremities with impaired sensation, shunt or fistula in involved extremity, mastectomy on involved side, or fracture on involved extremity.

D. **PROCEDURE:**

- i. Explain the procedure to the patient and assemble all needed equipment.
- ii. “Flush” the saline lock.
- iii. Choose appropriate size IV catheter. Remember to consider the intended therapy (i.e. trauma patients should have large bore IV access)

E. **Peripheral Extremity and Scalp Vein IV Access:**

- i. Apply a venous constricting band proximal to the desired puncture site.
- ii. Clean the desired puncture site and surrounding area with alcohol.
- iii. Perform vein puncture with the bevel of the needle up and observe blood return.
- iv. If blood return is noted advance the catheter and remove the needle if applicable
- v. Dispose of the needle in an appropriate sharps container
- vi. If indicated, draw blood samples.
- vii. Remove the venous constricting band if used
- viii. Flush the IV line with solution.
- ix. Assess the site for signs of infiltration or dislodgement
- x. Secure the catheter with an occlusive dressing and tape.
- xi. Secure the administration set and IV tubing as needed with tape or with Coban.

F. External Jugular Vein Cannulation

- i. DO NOT PERFORM THIS PROCEDURE ON BOTH EXTERNAL JUGULAR VEINS
- ii. Find the landmarks - midway between the angle of the jaw and the mid-point of the clavicle
- iii. Cleanse the desired puncture site and surrounding area with alcohol
- iv. If appropriate turn patient's head away from the intended site of insertion
- v. If appropriate place patient into a Trendelenburg position or hold your thumb over the vein to facilitate venous filling and insertion
- vi. Insert the catheter pointing towards the ipsilateral acromioclavicular joint until a flash fills the chamber of the catheter, then advance catheter over the needle, and remove needle.
- vii. Dispose of the needle in the appropriate sharps container.
- viii. Connect the administration set tubing to the cannula
- ix. Assess the site for signs of infiltration or dislodgement
- x. Secure the catheter with an occlusive dressing and tape
- xi. Secure the administration set and IV tubing as needed with tape

CCCIX. **DOCUMENTATION:** EMS charts

CCCX. **REFERENCES:** None